

Kinzoku Website — UI/UX Redesign Plan

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1. Goal and direction

Make Kinzoku’s site calm, precise and interactive so B2B buyers (pallet makers, wholesalers, nail producers) request a quote. Direction: **Precision Pastel** — the feel of a clean engineering datasheet, with chalk-white space, soft steel pastels, sharp type and motion that echoes wire being drawn.

Audit of the live site: charcoal + caution yellow reads "hardware store"; no scroll motion and little hover feedback; the page runs about 10,800 px at 800 px wide; CBAM / EN 10204 3.1 / EUR proof appears twice; the Long Products card has a placeholder icon; the cookie banner covers about a third of the first screen.

2. Colour and type

Pastels are used only as surfaces, all text is Graphite, and the current steel blue stays as Forge Navy. Graphite on every pastel scores 11 : 1 or better (WCAG AAA).

Token	Hex	Use
Chalk	#F7F5F0	Page background
Graphite	#1E2329	All text
Forge Navy	#2F4A63	Links, secondary buttons, footer
Butter	#F3D88A	Primary CTA, progress line (softened brand yellow)
Steel Mist	#DCE4EC	Products, header
Patina Sage	#DDE6DA	Process section
Clay Blush	#EEDFD6	About, quote

Fonts (free Google Fonts with Latin Extended for all 8 languages, loaded via `next/font`): **Archivo** semi-expanded 600–800 for headings (H1 40–76 px) · **Inter** 17–18 px, line height 1.65 for body · **IBM Plex Mono** 13 px uppercase for spec labels (Ø 2.1–3.8 MM). Nothing under 14 px.

3. Mouse and scroll interactions

Mouse effects answer the cursor; scroll effects tell the story. All motion is 200–600 ms and becomes simple fades for reduced-motion users.

- **Steel sheen:** product cards tilt up to 6° as a light sweep follows the cursor.
- **Magnetic CTA:** "Request a quote" leans toward the cursor and fills with Butter.
- **Hero spotlight:** a pastel glow follows the cursor over a faint wire-mesh pattern.
- **Wire story:** on scroll the process pins while a wire draws rod → drawing → nails → coils.
- **Scroll reveals:** headings rise in, images unmask, backgrounds drift between pastels.
- **Smart header:** hides on scroll down and returns frosted, with a Butter progress line.

4. Section changes

- **Hero:** short headline, coil photo, trust strip in place of the repeated feature grid.
- **Products:** photos on all 3 cards, spec chips, "View specs" drawer, photo mega-menu.
- **Why Kinzoku / About:** large figure tiles with icons; tinted panels led by the brand story.
- **Quote:** 4-step form: product → quantity → destination → contact.
- **Footer / cookies:** Forge Navy footer; a small 360 px cookie card, not a full banner.

5. What makes it memorable

1. **Wire thread:** a line runs from hero to quote form — *from wire rod to factory gate*.
2. **Steel sheen,** reused on cards, the quote button and the logo.
3. **Name mark:** *Kinzoku* (金属) means "metal" in Japanese; a small 金属 seal, if approved.
4. **Closing wordmark:** a full-width KINZOKU fills with Butter at the end of the page.

6. Build and rollout

Reskin the existing Next.js + Tailwind site: Tailwind tokens, Motion for hover and reveals, GSAP ScrollTrigger for the wire story, Lenis smooth scroll. Targets: LCP < 2.5 s, CLS < 0.1, INP < 200 ms, WCAG 2.2 AA.

Phases: tokens and components → page rebuild → signature interactions → quote flow, 8-language QA, launch. Client to supply a Long Products photo.